

GOALMILLS

Training Resources & Handbooks

Complete Sports Media & Publishing Master Curriculum (30-Day Onboarding)

Writing • SEO • Canva Graphics • Video Production • Verification • Newsroom Ops

30-Day Sports Media Employee Training Curriculum

Program: GoalMills Sports Media Academy | Duration: 30 working days | Daily Stand-up: 5:00 PM–5:30 PM WAT (Google Meet)

Training Model: Learn -> Create -> Publish -> Submit -> Review -> Improve. This is a production-based training program, not a reading program. Every working day, staff must study assigned lessons, produce and verify original content, publish live to website and social channels, and submit daily reports before attending the 5:00 PM stand-up review.

Daily Evaluation Scorecard (100 Points Total)

- Research (15 pts): Primary sourcing depth, fact verification, zero unverified claims.
- Accuracy (15 pts): Correct player names, scores, statistics, competition data.
- Writing (15 pts): Inverted pyramid, 3-sentence lead, active voice, zero editorial fluff.
- SEO (10 pts): Search intent alignment, optimized title, meta description, clean URL slug, internal linking.
- Social Media (10 pts): Platform-specific formatting, compelling hooks, relevant hashtags, comment engagement.
- Graphics / Design (10 pts): Canva brand kit consistency, typography hierarchy, safe margins, high contrast.
- Video Content (10 pts): 30-60s vertical scripts, clear voiceover, dynamic captions, zero pirated broadcast footage.
- Discipline & Teamwork (15 pts): On-time daily report submission (5), stand-up participation (5), peer review (5).

30-Day Phased Progression

Week 1 (Days 1–7): Sports Journalism Foundation — Observe + Practice (100% Supervision). Basics of news writing, 5 Ws + H, inverted pyramid, fact-checking, and week 1 exam.

Week 2 (Days 8–14): Content Strategy & Social Media — High supervision. Multi-channel syndication (X, FB, IG, TikTok), community management, 7-day content calendar, and week 2 exam.

Week 3 (Days 15–21): Canva Visuals & Video Production — Moderate supervision. Sports graphics design, infographics, vertical video scripts (Reels/Shorts/TikTok), YouTube, and breaking news simulation.

Week 4 (Days 22–30): Professional Newsroom & Independence — Light supervision to full independent operation. Live matchday coverage, audience retention, analytics review, final simulation, and portfolio certification.

GOALMILLS DAILY REPORT FORMAT
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STAFF NAME: [Your Name] DATE: [YYYY-MM-DD]
TRAINING DAY (#1-30): [Day] TODAY'S LESSON: [Topic]

WHAT I LEARNED:
1. [Core journalistic or technical takeaway]
2. [SOP rule applied]

CONTENT PRODUCED:
- ARTICLE URL: <https://goalmills-web.vercel.app/news/...>
- SOCIAL URL: <https://x.com/goalmills/...>
- CANVA GRAPHIC LINK: [Link]

SOURCES VERIFIED: [1. Club statement | 2. Tier-1 reporter]

WHAT WENT WELL: [Summary]

CHALLENGE / BLOCKER: [Notes]

IMPROVEMENT FOR TOMORROW: [Target]
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Part 1 & 2: Sports Media Business & Niche Strategy

A successful sports platform is not simply a blog where articles are posted—it is a sports intelligence ecosystem and multi-channel content engine.

The 4 Core Assets GoalMills Builds

- Asset 1: Content Library (Evergreen guides, player profiles, statistics databases, match centers).
- Asset 2: Audience (Engaged fans across website, app, newsletter, and social channels).
- Asset 3: Brand Reputation (Recognized for Speed + Accuracy + Deep Analysis).
- Asset 4: Owned Distribution (Direct visitors, WhatsApp broadcast, push notifications, email list).

Football-First Niche Model

GoalMills operates on a 70/30 sport distribution: 70% Football (European top leagues, UEFA Champions League, AFCON, Super Eagles, and Nigerian players abroad) and 30% Other major sports (Basketball/NBA, Cricket, Athletics, Tennis).

Core Content Mix: 35% Breaking News & Transfers, 25% Evergreen SEO & Guides, 20% Matchday Coverage, 10% Deep Tactical Analysis, 10% Features & Fan Debates.

Part 4: News Discovery & Verification Hierarchy

GoalMills enforces a strict 5-tier news sourcing pyramid to guarantee accuracy and build long-term reader trust.

- Tier 1 (100% Trust): Official club websites, league portals, federations, verified player accounts, press conferences.
- Tier 2 (High Credibility): Recognized specialist reporters (e.g. David Ornstein, Fabrizio Romano) and tier-1 sports outlets (BBC, Sky, The Athletic).
- Tier 3 (Specialist Media): Secondary football blogs and aggregators (Must cross-check claims).
- Tier 4 (Social Media): Leads on X/Instagram/TikTok (Strictly leads; requires independent verification).
- Tier 5 (Fan Accounts/Forums): Unverified tips (Never publish as fact).

The Two-Source Rule

Major transfer or disciplinary claims require either ONE primary official source or TWO independent, highly reputable reports. Unconfirmed reports must be explicitly labelled as "Reports suggest..." or "Transfer Rumour" — never as a done deal.

Part 5: How to Write Professional Sports Articles

Great sports writing answers "What happened?", "Why does it matter?", and "So what?". Follow the structured inverted pyramid approach.

The 3-Sentence Introduction Formula

- Sentence 1: What happened? (e.g. Arsenal defeated Chelsea 3-1 at the Emirates Stadium on Saturday.)
- Sentence 2: What was the key factor? (e.g. Bukayo Saka played a decisive role after tactical adjustments at halftime.)
- Sentence 3: Why does it matter? (e.g. The victory keeps Arsenal firmly in the Premier League title race while increasing pressure on Chelsea.)

Core Writing SOPs

- One Idea Per Paragraph: 2–4 short sentences per paragraph for mobile readability.
- The Quote Sandwich: Context -> Direct Quote -> Tactical/Consequential Explanation.
- Data With Purpose: Use statistics to prove a point (e.g. "Arsenal won 11 attacking third recoveries") rather than dumping raw numbers.
- What Next Section: End every article with upcoming fixtures, table implications, and next steps.

REUSABLE MATCH REPORT STRUCTURE

[HEADLINE: Arsenal 3-1 Chelsea: Saka Inspires Dramatic Comeback Victory]
[INTRODUCTION: 3-sentence lead with result, star performer, and table consequence]
[FIRST HALF: Early Chelsea dominance and tactical setup]
[TACTICAL TURNING POINT: How Arsenal altered pressing structure after interval]
[SECOND HALF & GOALS: Decisive strikes and key moments]
[NUMBERS THAT MATTER: 62% possession, 7 shots on target, 11 attacking recoveries]
[WHAT IT MEANS: League title race standings and tournament impact]
[WHAT'S NEXT: Upcoming derby fixture against Tottenham]

Part 7 & 19: Canva Sports Graphic Design System

Every GoalMills graphic must be instantly recognizable in social feeds. Follow the Brand Kit specifications strictly.

Brand Specifications

- Primary Background: Deep Navy (#0B1220 or #001F3F)
- Primary Accent: GoalMills Green (#10B981) | Alert: Red (#EF4444) | Gold: (#F59E0B)
- Typography: Montserrat ExtraBold / Bebas Neue (Headlines), Inter / Montserrat (Body & Stats)
- The 3-Second Rule: Headline, main subject, and score/topic must be clear in 3 seconds.

Core Master Templates

- 01 Breaking News | 02 Transfer Watch | 03 Matchday Preview | 04 Starting XI Lineup
- 05 Goal Alert | 06 Half-Time Score | 07 Full-Time Result | 08 Player of the Match
- 09 Statistics Infographic | 10 Quote Card | 11 Instagram 6-Slide Carousel | 12 YouTube Thumbnail

Part 20: Sports Video Production & Copyright Laws

Produce faceless and presenter-led sports videos without copyright risks. Video is a core traffic driver for GoalMills.

30-Second Video Script Formula

- 0–3s (Hook): "Arsenal just exposed Chelsea's biggest tactical problem."
- 3–10s (What Happened): "Arteta's side came from behind to win 3-1, but the key shift was after the break."
- 10–20s (Tactical Reason): "Arsenal pressed aggressively and forced 11 turnovers in the final third."
- 20–27s (Why It Matters): "This keeps the Gunners on top of the table with crucial momentum."
- 27–30s (CTA): "Follow GoalMills for daily football analysis."

Copyright Compliance

NEVER download and re-upload broadcast TV footage or pirated clips. Use official embed players, original narration, licensed stills, animated tactical boards, and copyright-cleared audio.

Part 8, 11 & 12: Sports SEO & Discovery Engine

Build compounding organic traffic across Google Search, Google News, and Google Discover.

Key SEO Rules

- Search Intent: Answer whether users want instant scores, transfer updates, stats, or analysis.
- Headlines & Metadata: Match H1 with page title (<60 chars) and craft compelling meta descriptions.
- Structured Data: Embed Schema.org NewsArticle, SportsEvent, and BreadcrumbList markup.
- Update Strategy: Update existing developing articles with timestamps rather than creating 10 duplicate thin pages.
- Zero Keyword Stuffing: Write for football fans first; integrate keywords naturally.

Part 13 & 21: Monetization & Newsroom Operations

Turn audience attention into a sustainable digital sports media enterprise.

Revenue Architecture

- Programmatic Ads: Google Ad Manager with clean, non-intrusive placements.
- Direct Sponsorships: Matchday Centre partners, Transfer Hub sponsors, Newsletter briefs.
- Affiliate Commerce: Sportswear, official tickets, streaming platforms.
- GoalMills Pro & Data API: Advanced sports analytics, ad-free experience, B2B data widgets.

The Newsroom Golden Rule

"Speed gets you noticed. Accuracy keeps you trusted. Originality makes you valuable. Consistency makes you grow. Never sacrifice accuracy just to be first."